

On research visibility, reach, and impact: a cook's tour

Outline

1. Identifier
2. Writing for a broader audience
3. Tracking attention
4. Media comment
5. Tracking impact
6. Questions

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The Conversation

Story

In one sentence, what will your article say? *

50 word limit

Why does the general public need to know about this and why now? *

100 word limit

What key points and examples will you use to support your argument?

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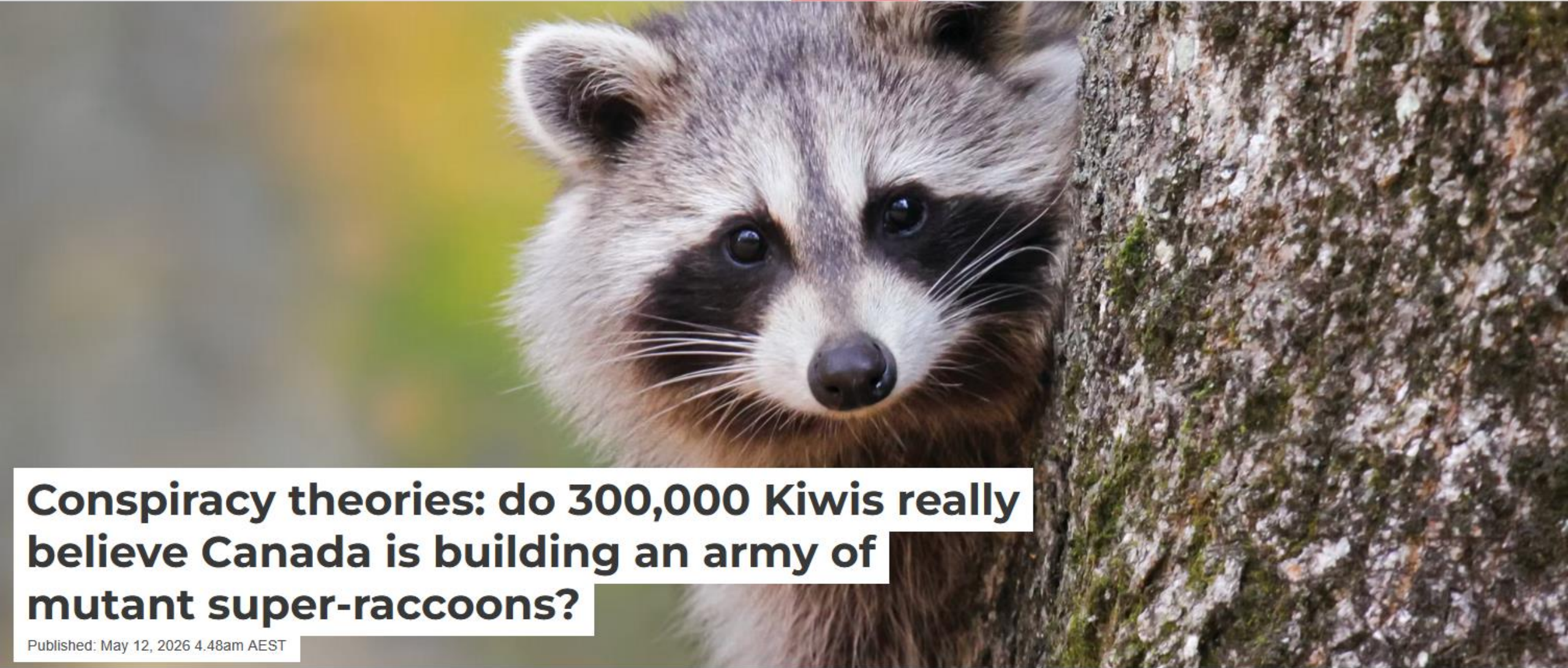
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Please select the most appropriate section for your pitch *

- ☐ Arts + Culture
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A close-up photograph of a raccoon's face as it peeks out from a hole in a tree trunk. The raccoon has its characteristic black and grey fur, white chest, and dark eye patches. Its long white whiskers are prominent. The background is a soft-focus green, suggesting a forest setting.

Conspiracy theories: do 300,000 Kiwis really believe Canada is building an army of mutant super-raccoons?

Published: May 12, 2026 4.48am AEST

Conspiracy theories: do 300,000 Kiwis really believe Canada is building an army of mutant super-raccoons?

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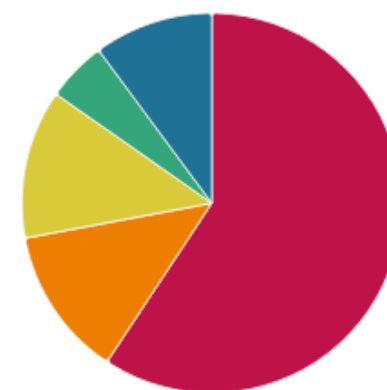
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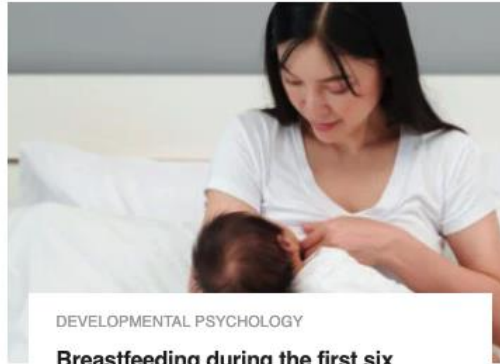
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COGNITIVE SCIENCE

Video games might offer a small boost to memory and mental skills

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DEVELOPMENTAL PSYCHOLOGY

Breastfeeding during the first six months is linked to better sleep at one year

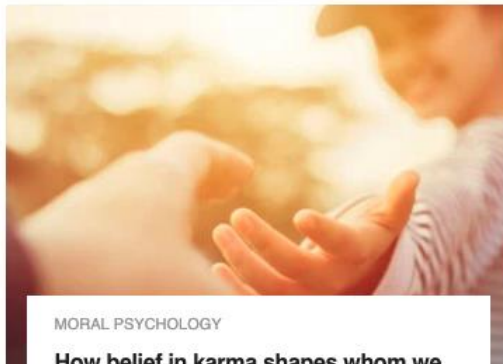
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AUTHORITARIANISM

Study explores how cultural tightness shapes personality and political beliefs

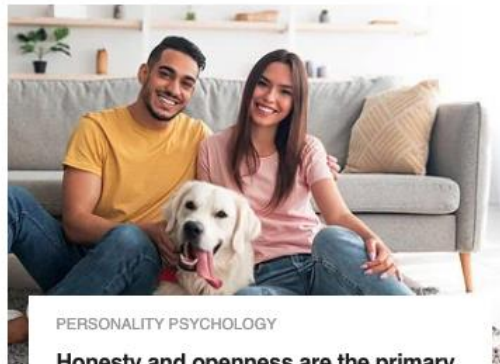
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MORAL PSYCHOLOGY

How belief in karma shapes whom we choose to help

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PERSONALITY PSYCHOLOGY

Honesty and openness are the primary personality traits that long-term couples share

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ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

Experts and the public have radically different visions of an automated future

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<https://psypost.org>

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Do you really believe that? Examining the prevalence and predictors of belief in conspiracy theories when accounting for insincerity

Overview of attention for article published in Royal Society Open Science, May 2026



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Mentioned by

12 news outlets
1 blog
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Title Do you really believe that? Examining the prevalence and predictors of belief in conspiracy theories when accounting for insincerity

Published in Royal Society Open Science, May 2026

DOI 10.1098/rsos.260163

Authors [Matt Williams](#), [Mathew D. Marques](#), [Mathew Ling](#), [Stephen Hill](#), [John Kerr](#), ... [\[show\]](#)

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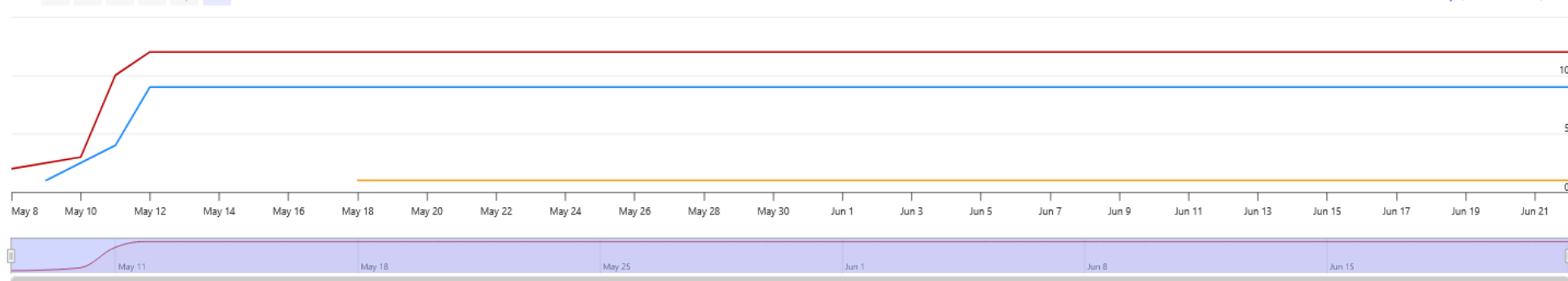
Timeline

Attention Score in Context

Attention over time

Zoom 1m 3m 6m YTD 1y All

May 8, 2026 → Jun 22, 2026



NEWS

BLOGS

BLUESKY



Google Scholar

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ResearchGate

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<https://researchgate.net>

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ABOUT

RESEARCH OUTPUTS

RESEARCH

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

TEACHING



DR

Mathew Marques

ID 0000-0002-5486-650X

BIO

Dr Marques uses social psychology to understand the role of psychological mechanisms (e.g., trust, conspiracy theories, ideologies) in the formation of attitudes towards socially contentious scientific research (e.g., genetically modified foods, vaccinations), and more broadly in science communication. He is also interested in the role of epistemological processes such as anti-intellectualism in the evaluation of emerging technologies, and how these and other values shape judgments of scientific actors. Mathew also researches the tall poppy syndrome, and the effects of differing status and aspects such as deservingness on attitudes towards tall poppies and underdogs. Dr Marques is an expert in quantitative modeling techniques such as multilevel modeling and various forms of structural equation modeling.

Mathew is an Associate Editor for the Journal of Social Psychology, part of the Social Science Advisory group at the National Centre for Immunisation Research and Surveillance, and a member of the Society of Australasian Social Psychologists, and International Society of Political Psychology.

<https://scholars.latrobe.edu.au>

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Helping scientists work effectively with the news media

Dealing with the media can be a challenge.
Find resources here to make it easier.



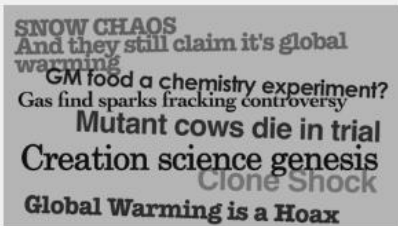
Dealing with the news media

Be ready for media exposure,
follow these short videos



Using social media

Use social media to communicate
better professionally



Contentious research

Learn to deal with those
controversial science situations



Handling online harassment

How to protect yourself if you are
facing harassment online when
engaging with the media and public

Media at La Trobe Uni

Daily Media Report is available to all staff. This is a consolidated report of media coverage highlights that mention La Trobe. If you know someone who'd like to receive it, they can contact us to be added via media@latrobe.edu.au .

Media and social media training sessions for academics

Thursday 16 July, 12-1pm (in-person and online media and social media training, Bundoora campus, WLT2)

Thursday 3 September, 12-1pm (in-person and online media and social media training, Bundoora campus)

Wednesday 7 October, 12-1pm (in-person and online media and social media training, Bendigo campus)

Informal drop-in sessions

Tuesday 18 August, 12-1pm (in-person drop-in session with the media and social media team, Bundoora campus)

Thursday 5 November, 12-1pm (in person drop-in session with the media and social media team, Bundoora campus)

<https://intranet.latrobe.edu.au/know-our-organisation/news/2026/media-and-social-media-training-sessions-for-academics>

Track and evidence impact

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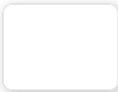
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Publication



Conspiracy theories: What they are and how to spot them?

UK UK Parliament Research Briefings

Conspiracy theories can have social and political consequences, but why do people believe them and what conversational techniques work to address them?

What's this about?

Conspiracy theories and their impact on public life

Full description

Conspiracy theory Belief Cognition

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Practical recommendations to communicate with patients about health-related conspiracy theories

Medical Journal of Australia
Mathew D Marques et al. (2022)

... Link in text to https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.5694/mja2.51475 ...

On page 1

Be mindful what you are called



Questions ?